

Check the status of transaction wraparound Runbook

Here the link to the video of the runbook simulation.

Intro

The autovacuum process executes a “special” maintenance task called **to prevent wraparound** or **wraparound protection** on tables that the TXID reaches the `autovacuum_freeze_max_age`. Sometimes this activity can be annoying in a high workload on the database server due to the expense of consuming additional resources. A manual `VACUUM FREEZE` command helps avoid this “situation”, but running `VACUUM FREEZE` on the entire database can slow down the database server, hence the importance of monitoring and executing it by table (especially on big tables) is a smart decision.

Verify the status wraparound on each table in GitLab

It is important to monitor the TXID of the tables to check if this table is near to a wraparound, with the following script you can check the tables’ status and generate `FREEZE` command, please execute on the **leader** (primary) server:

You can check the **help** and see the parameters for the script

```
sh wraparound.sh -h
```

Script for check wraparound status and generate `FREEZE` command

```
wraparound.sh -m check -p 95
```

options

mode: `-m check/generate` (default `check`)

size: `-s size threshold of tables to check/generate` (default `10000000000 [10GB]`)

percent: `-p % threshold of age` (default `95`)

Only 9% of tables exceeding 10GB of size, and these tables are 97% size of the whole database

Mode options

- `check`: Show which tables are exceeding the threshold of `-s(size)` and `-p` (percent of TXID age)
- `generate`: Return commands to run to prevent wraparound tables from exceeding the threshold of `-s(size)` and `-p` (percent of TXID age)

```
#check tables with more than 95 % of TXID and more than 10GB
```

```
sh wraparound.sh -p 95 -m check -s 10000000000
```

You will get an output similar to:

```

mode: check, size: 10000000000, percent: 95
  full_table_name | pg_size_pretty | freeze_age | percent
-----+-----+-----+-----
push_event_payloads | 72 GB          | 188675977 |      98
notes              | 431 GB         | 184676635 |      96
(2 rows)

```

The previous query filter the tables bigger than 10GB and more than 95% of freeze_age (can change if needed)

Execute FREEZE maintenance task in GitLab

To execute the FREEZE maintenance task you can get the commands from the following query:

```
sh wraparound.sh -p 95 -m generate -s 10000000000
```

The previous query returns the FREEZE commands for maintenance (can filter by tablename)

You will get an output similar to:

```

mode: generate, size: 10000000000, percent: 95
                                command
-----+-----
VACUUM FREEZE ANALYZE push_event_payloads; select pg_sleep(2);
VACUUM FREEZE ANALYZE notes; select pg_sleep(2);
(2 rows)

```

You can execute the previous commands in the **leader(primary)** server on off-peak times so as not to impact the primary server due to the expense of consuming additional IO resources.

for example:

```

gitlabhq_production=# VACUUM FREEZE ANALYZE system_note_metadata; select pg_sleep(2);
VACUUM
pg_sleep
-----
(1 row)

```

Please, when executing these commands see the dashboard to monitoring patroni